

VR Experiment Session Script

Welcome & Introduction

Hi! Thank you so much for coming today. You can leave your things here and take a seat. We'll get started in just a moment.

So, this project is part of my master's thesis at the University of the Arts London, Creative Computing Institute. I'm studying how people interact with AI characters in virtual reality and how those interactions feel.

This is not a test. There are no right or wrong answers. I'm simply interested in the interaction aspect of the experiment and the outcomes of it.

Consent & Data

Before we start, I'll give you a quick overview of how your data will be handled. Just to let you know, this session may be recorded. That includes what happens inside VR, your voice, and sometimes a short video of the experimentation session. However, all of this will stay confidential, anonymised, and stored securely.

You'll also sign a consent form that explains your rights, including the option to withdraw your data later if you wish. Participation is completely voluntary, and you can stop at any time without any issue. You just need to let me know.

(Hand them the consent form, let them read and sign, answer questions.)

Pre-questionnaire

Before putting on the headset, there's a short questionnaire. It's just a quick way to get your initial opinion on a short statement before the VR experience begins. It only takes about an instant.

Equipment & Controls

Alright, let's move on to the headset. You'll be using two controllers, one in each hand, but the only button you really need is the A button on your right-hand controller.

Here's how it works:

- When you hold down the A button, the character will listen to you. Speak naturally at a decent volume while keeping the button pressed.
- When you release the button, that means you've finished speaking. So, your answer is locked in, and the character will start replying.
- If the character is already talking and you press A, it will stop and start listening to you instead.

As a result, it's a real back-and-forth type of conversation. You take turns speaking and listening. However, you always have speaking priority over the character.

The whole conversation will last around three to five minutes. However, if it lasts a bit longer, this should not be a problem, and please don't focus on the time you spend talking. If I feel that the conversation is lasting way too long, I'll let you know so we can finish the experiment.

ALSO! If at any point you feel dizzy, uncomfortable, or want to stop, just tell me and I'll remove the headset immediately.

(Help them put on the headset, and check comfort and visibility.)

Explaining the Conversation Focus

The following part is crucial. Once the experience starts, you'll meet a virtual character who will introduce a **specific topic**. Please engage with *that topic*, so share your own thoughts, opinions, or reactions as naturally as you can, just as you would in a normal conversation.

I'll be analyzing the conversation later, so try to stay focused on what the character brings up, and try to give your own opinion on the matter.

There's no right or wrong response here. I just want to understand how the discussion flows.

Alright, are you ready to start?

During the Experience

You'll see the character in front of you. Once you're ready, you can start interacting using the A button like we discussed. I'll stay here monitoring everything, but I won't interfere unless it's necessary.

After the Experience

Okay, that's the end of the session. Let me help you take off the headset.

How do you feel? If you need to take a moment, please feel free to do so.

Now, there's a short follow-up questionnaire again. (Sorry about that). It asks about your impressions and what you thought of the conversation. It should take only a few minutes.

Closing & Thank-You

That's everything for today. Thank you so much for participating. Your input is really valuable for my research.

If you ever wish to withdraw your data, your anonymous code is on the form, so just email me using the address provided within seven days.

And if you gave permission for short clips to be used, they'll only appear in academic presentations or my thesis documentation, never in any public or commercial setting.

Thanks again! I really appreciate your time!